

"The customer may become the organisation rather than the individual student. Companies may decide to invest in developing employees through customised programmes"

Q: As ISB seeks to attract more global students, what should applicants consider when comparing it with other leading management institutions?

A: One of the things that is changing is the attractiveness of India as an environment where people can learn and build their careers. Historically, students often went to global institutions because they wanted access to those economies and labour markets. That equation is changing as India becomes a larger growth opportunity.

The promise for international students is not only that they will receive a high-quality education, but that they will also be exposed to a business environment that is evolving rapidly. India provides examples of how companies operate in complex markets, how innovation happens under constraints and how businesses create solutions at scale.

Twenty-five or thirty years ago, people looked at leading American business schools to understand how successful companies were built. The ambition is that, in the future, people will look at India to understand how businesses can be built and scaled in complex environments.

Q: Beyond educating business leaders, what role can institutions like ISB play in shaping public policy and national development?

A: Business schools cannot focus only on private companies. They also have a role in contributing to public policy because businesses operate within larger economic and institutional environments.

At ISB, the creation of the Bharti Institute of Public Policy reflected the belief that research institutions should contribute data, analysis and frameworks that policymakers can use. The role of a business school is not to make policy decisions, but to provide rigorous research and evidence that can inform those decisions.

Business schools can also work with industry bodies and organisations by providing research that helps them understand challenges and engage more effectively with policymakers.

Q: As the demand for new skills grows, how do you see companies participating in the future of management education?

A: Companies will play an increasingly important role because they are ultimately looking for capabilities that help them succeed. If there are models that demonstrate value, companies will participate.

The relationship may become more customised. Instead of employees simply enrolling in a traditional programme, companies may identify specific capabilities they need and work with institutions to build those programmes.

Q: What challenges will business schools face as they move towards a more flexible and evolving education model?

A: The challenge is that organisations have historically been built around a particular model. Large cohorts